DRUGS · ANTIFUNGALS AND ANTIVIRALS

Nystatin and miconazole oral gel

Nystatin suspension and miconazole oral gel treat oral candidiasis (thrush) by direct contact with the mucosa. They are the first step for pseudomembranous candidiasis, denture stomatitis and angular cheilitis. Miconazole is absorbed enough to interact dangerously with warfarin.

1 CHAPTER ONE At a glance

The drugs on one page.

1.1 Summary

NYSTATIN AND MICONAZOLE ORAL GEL

	SUMMARY
Agents	Nystatin oral suspension 100,000 units/ml (a polyene); miconazole oral gel 20 mg/g (an imidazole)
ENT uses	Oral thrush (in infants, inhaled steroid users, after antibiotics, during radiotherapy); denture stomatitis; angular cheilitis (miconazole cream or gel)
Adult dose	Nystatin 1 ml four times daily after food, held in the mouth, for 7 days and continued for 48 hours after resolution; miconazole gel 2.5 ml four times daily after food, held in the mouth, for 7 days and 7 days after resolution
Child dose	Nystatin 1 ml four times daily; miconazole gel 4 months to 2 years 1.25 ml four times daily, older children 2.5 ml four times daily
Avoid	Miconazole with warfarin; miconazole in infants under 4 months or with poor swallowing (choking)

2 CHAPTER TWO Using them in ENT

Indications.

2.1 Practice

Treat the cause (rinse after steroid inhalers, review antibiotics, check glucose and HIV status if unexplained). For dentures, remove them at night and soak them in an antifungal or chlorhexidine solution, and apply the gel to the fitting surface. Fluconazole is used for extensive or resistant infection and in the immunocompromised.

3 CHAPTER THREE Safety

What goes wrong.

3.1 Adverse effects

Nystatin: nausea, unpleasant taste. Miconazole: nausea, taste change.

3.2 Interactions

Miconazole inhibits CYP2C9 and CYP3A4 even as an oral gel: it markedly raises the **INR with warfarin** (bleeding deaths have been reported) and raises levels of sulfonylureas, phenytoin and some statins. Avoid with warfarin, or monitor INR very closely.

4 CHAPTER FOUR For the examination

What the examiner wants to hear.

4.1 Viva essentials

WHAT THE EXAMINER IS LOOKING FOR

- The **miconazole and warfarin** interaction.

- Contributing causes of oral candidiasis.

4.2 Common pitfalls

COMMON PITFALLS

- Prescribing miconazole gel to a patient on warfarin.

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